Wood chipper maintenance schedule

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For towable disc and drum brush chippers. Knives are the whole game. Sharp knives pull wood in and save the engine, belts and bearings.

Chipper makers publish less of their schedules than most, so treat this sheet as the minimum and check your manual, especially for bearing grease, where over-greasing can do damage too.

Break-in (new chippers)

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
Check drum drive belt tension	After the first 10 hours		
Check wheel lug nut torque	After the first 10 hours		

Every day or 10 hours

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
Inspect knives on both sides	About every 10 hours	Cracked or bent means replace, not flip	
Check knife-to-anvil (bedknife) gap	Daily	And any time you work on the drum	
Check engine oil	Daily		
Check the engine drive belt	Daily		
Grease bearings and pivots	Per your manual	Don't over-grease	

By hours

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
Rotate or sharpen knives, check knife bolt torque	Weekly or about 50 hours	Sooner in dirty wood	
Check drum belt tension	Every 50 hours		
Check lug nut torque	Every 100 hours		
Replace the drum drive belt	About every 500 hours	Sooner if worn	

Rules of thumb

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
Knife bolts	Reuse for one flip, then replace	Metal fatigue	
Trailer: axle, bearings, brakes, lights	See the trailer schedule		

Service log: wood chipper

Machine / unit: _____ Make & model: _____

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DATE	HOURS	WORK DONE	PARTS USED	INITIALS

Free printable from fleetoptima.org/maintenance-schedules